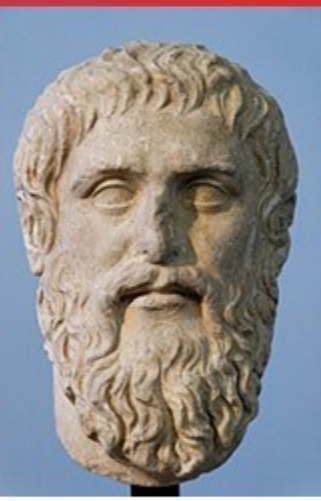
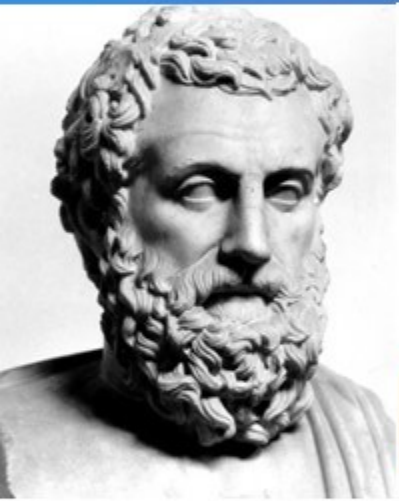


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



ATTITUDE

MODULE – 21

**ATTITUDE CHANGE,
PERSUASION**

ATTITUDE CHANGE

Bringing about a change in people's attitudes is of interest to politicians, community leaders, advertisers, producers of consumer goods and others.



Attitudes which are in the formative stage or weak are more likely to change than attitudes that are firmly established and have become a part of individual's values.

Attitude change occurs primarily because of two reasons:

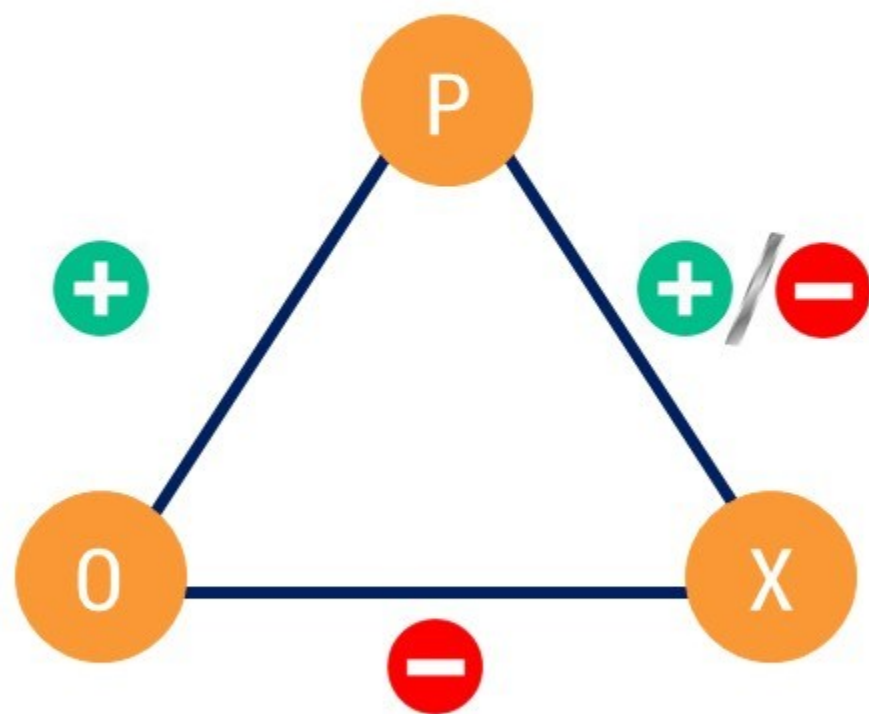
One: Because of the communication and behavior of other people. Attitudes are subject to change by social influences.

Two: They also change by the individual's motivation to maintain cognitive consistency when cognitive dissonance (when two attitudes or an attitude and behaviour conflict) occurs.

BALANCE THEORY

FRITZ HEIDER

There are three major concepts that explain some important processes in attitude change.



P is getting his son married off to the daughter of O, and X is dowry, the attitude topic.

Balance Theory: It can be easily explained in the **P-O-X triangle** which represents the relationship between three components of the attitude.

P is the person whose attitude is studied, O is another person and X is either the object of the attitude or another person.

The attitude **changes** if there is an **imbalance** between P-O, O-X and P-X attitudes because imbalance is logically uncomfortable, and the attitude changes in the direction of the balance.

Imbalance: (i) all three sides are negative (ii) two sides are positive and one side negative. **Balance:** (i) all three sides are positive (ii) two sides are negative and one side positive.

COGNITIVE DISSONANCE

LEON FESTINGER

Cognition I: Smoking Kills**Cognition II: I smoke**

The basic idea is that the **cognitive components** of an attitude must be logically in line with each other (they **must be consonant**).

If two cognitions in an attitude are **dissonant** (opposite of consonant), then **one** of them **will be changed** in the direction of consonance.

Both the balance and the cognitive dissonance theories are **examples of cognitive consistency**, which means that the two components, elements or aspects of the attitude or attitude system must be in the same direction.

In case of dissonance, the person experiences discomfort in the attitude system and one of the aspects changes in the direction of consistency.

As per this concept, attitude change takes place in two steps.



SOURCE



TARGET

Step I: Target identifies with the source

Step II: Source shows an attitude change

STEP I: the **target** of the change **identifies** with the **source**.

Target - the person whose attitude is to be changed.

Source - the person through whose influence the change is to take place.

Identification: the target has liking and regard for the source, tries to put himself/herself in the place of the target and tries to feel like him/her.

STEP II: the **source** shows an **attitude** change by changing her/his behaviour towards the attitude object. Observing this change, **the target imitates the change**.

PERSUASION

Persuasion is a form of social influence on attitude.

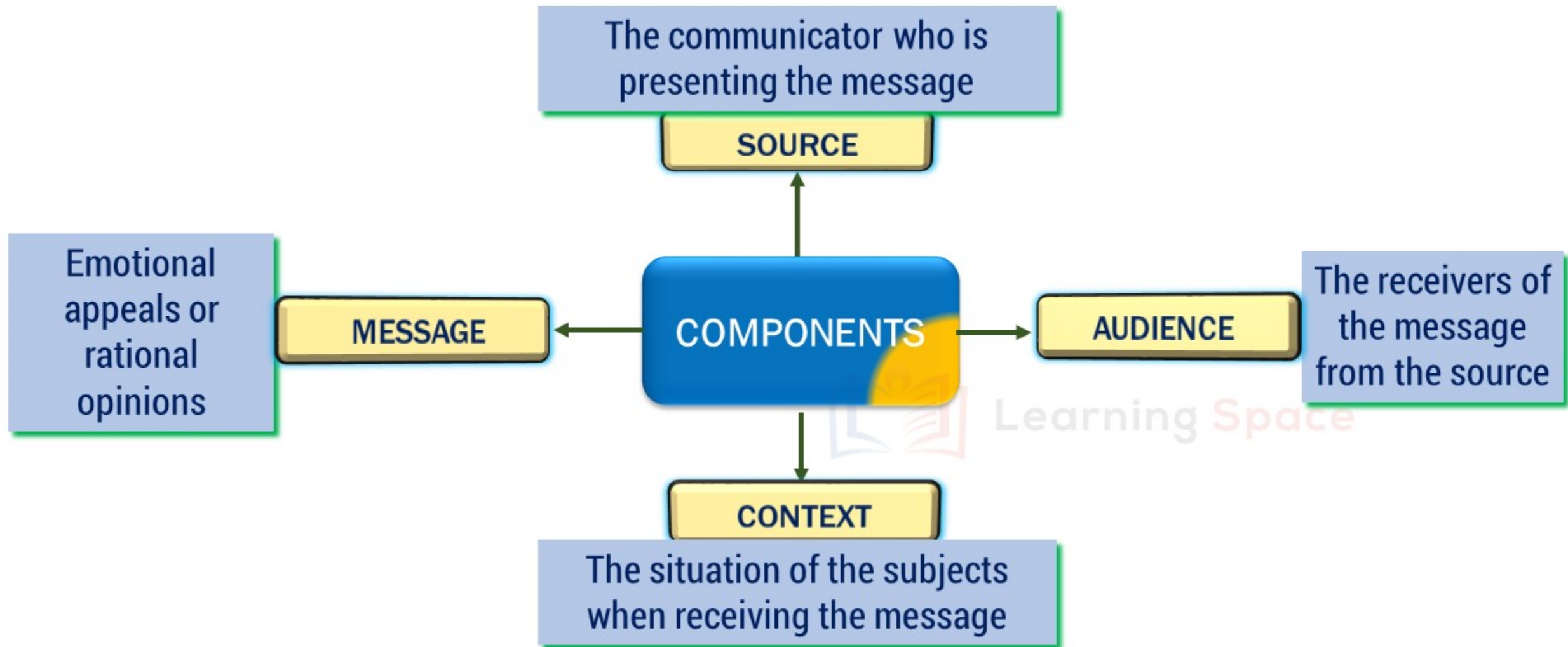


Heuristic-Systematic Model of Persuasion and Elaboration Likelihood Model of Persuasion are two models that explain how persuasion works.

Persuasion is a process in which communicators try to convince their target audience to change their attitudes or behaviours through transmission of a message.

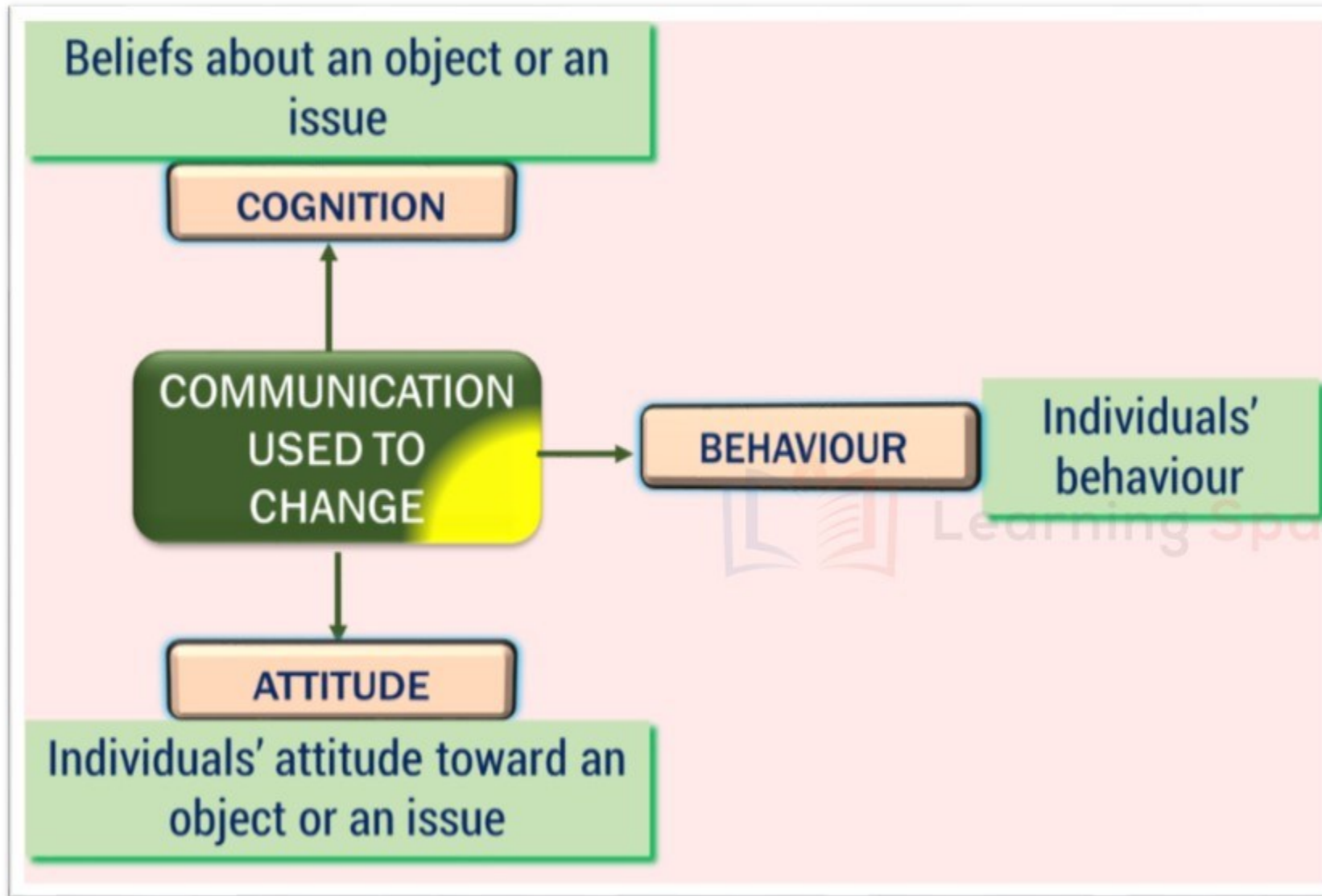
- Persuasion involves deliberate attempts to influence other people's opinions.
- Persuasion may use words, images or sounds.
- Sometimes people persuade themselves (self-persuasion).
- Resorting to coercion as part of persuasion may prove ineffective in the long run.
- Persuasion involves the components: the source, medium, context and the audience.

THE COMPONENTS OF PERSUASION



ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

PERSUASION DIRECTED AT



HEURISTIC-SYSTEMATIC MODEL OF PERSUASION

This theory suggests attitudes can change in two fundamentally different ways.



Shelly Chaiken

One way is through **systematic processing**. People think carefully about any available information when forming an opinion to determine whether the information is accurate or valid. Attitudes are then based on the conclusions from this careful consideration of the facts.

But, this kind of thinking **takes a lot of effort**. As people usually only have **limited time** and **ability** to think carefully, the heuristic-systematic model **suggests that attitudes are often formed in a more simplified manner**.

This **simplified form of attitude judgment** is called **heuristic processing** that involves using **rules of thumb** known as **heuristics** to decide what one's attitudes should be.

HEURISTIC-SYSTEMATIC MODEL OF PERSUASION

A political speech might be more convincing when a lot of people in the audience clap than when fewer people clap. A consumer product might seem better when it is the last one left on the shelf.



When using the **consensus heuristic**, attitudes are simply based on the opinions that the majority of other people hold.

If a dentist recommends a certain type of toothpaste for fighting cavities, then it must work. If sportsmen drink a particular brand of energy drink, then it must be good or nutritious.



When using the **expert heuristic**, attitudes are simply based on the perceived expertise of the person delivering the message.

HEURISTIC-SYSTEMATIC MODEL OF PERSUASION

The same essay might be more convincing when presented in double-spaced format than when it is in single-spaced format, even though the content of the essay is exactly the same in both instances.



The **message length heuristic** suggests **that longer messages**, which seem to contain a lot of arguments, **are more convincing** because people infer that the length of the message implies it is strong or correct (i.e., length implies strength).

Heuristic rules of thumb are **only used to the degree that the rule seems valid and reliable**.

Not everyone thinks experts are always right, and in such cases, people are obviously less likely to follow expert advice.

The consensus heuristic may be **called into question when** a political opinion poll is based on a very small number of respondents, in which case people tend to stop using this heuristic.

SHORTCOMINGS

HEURISTIC-SYSTEMATIC MODEL: BIASES

As per this model, opinions can be biased in a number of different ways.



Whose recommendation would you follow when buying a laptop?



Heuristic rules can bias the thoughts that people have when they are thinking carefully about an issue (bias systematic processing).

When an argument seems more likely to be correct or persuasive because it comes from an expert compared to when the same argument comes from a less impressive information source.

Certain motives or goals can bias attitudes. People are typically assumed to be motivated to form accurate or correct opinions, known as accuracy motivation. However, defensive or impression motives can have an impact on attitudes.

Impression motives: people having a more positive attitude of themselves.



Impression motives can lead to biased attitudes. Individuals tend to alter their opinions so that they match the attitudes of important people to either fit in or get along with those other people.

While heuristic rules certainly lead people to the wrong conclusion at times, the use of such heuristics is an essential aspect of everyday life.

Persuasion heuristics provide a relatively easy way to make the numerous evaluations people are burdened with in their daily lives, and the use of these heuristics often leads people to adopt perfectly reasonable opinions.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

TWO EXAMPLES OF PERSUASION

BUYING JEWELLERY

A woman who is very much interested in jewellery will be closely watching the pertinent advertisements. Here, she has the motivation for the subject matter, cares about it, and carefully processes the message and thinks about it.

Her husband may not be interested in jewels so he will be totally ignoring the message from advertisements about the jewellery.

Here the woman processes the message in her **Central Route** but her husband doesn't.

BUYING A NOTE BOOK

Bikram, a high school student is in a book store to buy a note book for doing his homework. He sees many designs on front cover of the notebook from various companies.

He becomes confused, and then he sees a notebook with his favorite cricket player's picture on front cover. Without thinking much about it, he bought that notebook.

Here the student takes a **Peripheral Route** to make a decision on buying the note book.

ELABORATION LIKELIHOOD MODEL OF PERSUASION

Richard E. Petty and John T. Cacioppo made this theory based on the concept of persuasion.



The receiver should care about the message and subject matter.

This model proposes that each and every message undergoes the process of persuasion in two different ways: Central Route and Peripheral Route.

Both of them are effective persuasion techniques, but each of them has its own guiding techniques to make them more operative.

Central Route is straight to the point and complete.

A person who is distracted or having some problem with understanding the message may not be able to do the Central Processing.

ELABORATION LIKELIHOOD MODEL OF PERSUASION

The receiver should care about the message and subject matter.



Central Route is **strong** and the **involvement** of the receiver will be **high**.

- It **needs** a **thoughtful consideration** of arguments which are in the message.
- It **requires more involvement** from the part of reader or viewer. The **receiver** of the message **carefully analyses** the message and **thinks** of it in **every possible angle**.
- When the receiver processes the message through the central route, his/her **active participation** is **vital** also are his/her **motivation** and **ability to think**.

The **disadvantage** of this technique is that, if the receiver is not directly affected by the message he or she will ignore it.

ELABORATION LIKELIHOOD MODEL OF PERSUASION



This is where packing, marketing, advertising and PR play a vital role.

The **Peripheral Route** is **weak** and the **involvement** of the receiver will be **low**.

- The message sent through peripheral route is **not analysed cognitively**.
- The **receiver** of the message is **not sure** whether to agree with the message or to disagree.
- The person may **not** be **able to elaborate the message extensively**, so in the end he/she will be persuaded by the factors which are nothing to do with the message.

Sometimes people may not be in a position to think about the message carefully so he or she will **look around for the next best option to be persuaded**.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao
K. Srikanth
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu
M. Binukrishna
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9